



eCBHFA

Communicable disease prevention module

Facilitator guide for empowering communities



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eCBHFA

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Facilitator guide

The International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC) is the world's largest volunteer-based humanitarian network, reaching 150 million people each year through our 191 member National Societies. Together, we act before, during and after disasters and health emergencies to meet the needs and improve the lives of vulnerable people. We do so with impartiality as to nationality, race, gender, religious beliefs, class and political opinions.

Our strength lies in our volunteer network, our community-based expertise and our independence and neutrality. We work to improve humanitarian standards, as partners in development and in response to disasters. We persuade decision-makers to act at all times in the interests of vulnerable people. The result: we enable healthy and safe communities, reduce

vulnerabilities, strengthen resilience and foster a culture of peace around the world.

The IFRC is proud to work with USAID to help National Societies better prepare communities, National Societies, governments, civil society and the private sector to prevent, detect and respond to disease threats and play a significant role in preparing for future risks.

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Foreword

You are part of a global movement to protect every person from preventable illness. More and more, we are understanding that communicable diseases and disease outbreaks, begin and end in communities. When people get sick, before they go to a clinic, get laboratory tests, they are with their family and friends. As a disease spreads through a community, it is family members, friends and neighbours who are both most at risk of infection and have the most power to prevent the spread of a disease.

Red Cross and Red Crescent volunteers are embedded in communities, they are trusted family members, friends and neighbours. Because you, as a community volunteer, have a special role in your community, people may turn to you for advice when they or a family member gets sick. With the right knowledge and skills you can help members of your community to understand a disease, help them identify ways to prevent a disease from infecting them or their families, and make sure they know where to get care if they do get sick. As someone with special knowledge about how to protect your community, just by spreading the right information, to the right people, at the right time you can save lives and prevent ill-health.

This eCBHFA volunteer guide will equip you with the basics of Communicable Disease Prevention – how diseases are transmitted, and how to equip community members with the information and motivation to protect their families and communities from disease. No two communities, or even families are the same, and so the community understanding and ability to adapt our work is critical in this effort.

When communities are engaged and trained in epidemic preparedness and response, they become vital contributors to identifying and stopping outbreaks, saving lives, restoring services, reducing negative impacts, speeding recovery and building resilience.

Using the guides and toolkit

Communicable disease prevention volunteer guide

This guide is designed for community volunteers who work directly with community members. The guide contains key information and discussion points to work with community members in understanding risks involved across different disease transmission channels and how to minimise those risks.

The volunteer guide is comprised of seven topics which include knowledge, tools, talking points and activities for teaching communities in an interactive way.

Communicable disease prevention toolkit

The toolkit is designed to support both the Volunteer Guide and the Facilitator Guide with interactive tools, games and illustrative material. The toolkit is designed to be adapted and modified to local contexts, taking advantage of both local expertise and knowledge and differences in Ministry of Health approaches. Materials has been specifically designed to be printed in black and white or full colour, and with low-resource environments in mind.

Communicable disease prevention facilitator guide

This guide is designed for staff or trainers of trainers to conduct a training of trainers (ToT) or preparation course for staff and volunteers who will work directly with community members.

The Facilitator Guide allows volunteers hands-on experience with all the toolkit materials. Diagnostic tools to better understand community perceptions, barriers and individual concerns are also included.

Communicable disease prevention topics

Topic	Contents
1	Basics of communicable diseases
2	Transmission routes
3	Teaching disease prevention
4	Alerting authorities to possible disease outbreak
5	Basic health messaging

Topic 1

Basics of communicable diseases

Overview

Learn about what causes communicable diseases, how they spread, and what does not cause communicable diseases to spread. Understand that the reasons behind communicable disease transmission to help keep families and the community safe and healthy. Communicable diseases are caused by germs known as bacteria and viruses. There are multiple ways that communicable diseases can spread. Myths about the spread of communicable disease can be dangerous. Knowledge about the multiple ways communicable diseases are transmitted can help prevent the spread of these diseases.

Learning objectives

By the end of this topic, volunteers should be able to:

- Explain vocabulary: communicable disease, germ, bacteria, virus, transmission
- Say the causes of communicable diseases
- Explain transmission routes of communicable diseases and the main diseases transmitted through these routes
- Explain how myths about the spread of communicable diseases affect community health
- Teach the basics of communicable diseases to their community

Tools

- ❑ Basics of a communicable disease poster
- ❑ Transmission route posters (7)

Suggested outline of activities

Depending on the number of participants and amount of discussion, this topic will take approximately 1 hour, 55 minutes to complete.

Activity	Time
Introduction	20 minutes
Basics of communicable diseases	15 minutes
Reflection	10 minutes
Transmission routes	25 minutes
Reflection	10 minutes
Myths about communicable diseases	15 minutes
Reflection	10 minutes
Wrap-up	10 minutes
Total Time	115 minutes

Preparation

- Write the learning objectives for the topic on chart paper and post at the front of the room.
- Prepare copies of volunteer guide for topic and tools for each trainee.

Introduction

1. Welcome the volunteers to the module and this first topic. Tell them that this topic examines the basics of communicable diseases. Tell them that four additional topics will explore specifics about how communicable diseases can be prevented, how they can teach about prevention, when to alert authorities about possible communicable disease outbreaks, and a refresher on writing basic health messaging.
2. Introduce the topic objectives and explain the agenda and activities that they will do to meet those objectives.
3. Distribute the topic [Basics of Communicable Diseases](#) from the volunteer

guide.

- Explain that volunteers will be taught how to use two tools during the session and that they will be expected to practise using these tools and demonstrate their skill in delivering the content.
 - Allow approximately two minutes for the volunteers to become familiar with the topic materials.
4. Instruct volunteers to form groups of three or four. (If it is a mixed gender class, try to make sure there are both men and women in each group.) In their groups, volunteers should read the topic Basics of Communicable Diseases to themselves or as a group, whichever way they feel more comfortable.
 - After the group has completed reading, they should discuss the Reflection questions from the topic and be prepared for one of them to share their responses with the larger group during a plenary session.
 - Allow approximately 15 minutes for reading and discussion.
 5. After 15 minutes, hold a plenary session and ask each group to present their responses to the Reflection questions. Monitor responses and put right any misunderstandings or misinformation.

Role of the volunteer

1. Remind volunteers that they have three important roles as volunteers: teaching about disease prevention, being a first responder when people are hurt or become sick, and informing the appropriate authorities are first responders.
2. This module focuses on teaching their community about the various ways that communicable diseases can spread, and thus help with the prevention of disease transmission.
3. Tell volunteers that this module will help them to be able to do this, and that there are tools that will remind them of the important points they need to make when teaching their community about communicable diseases.

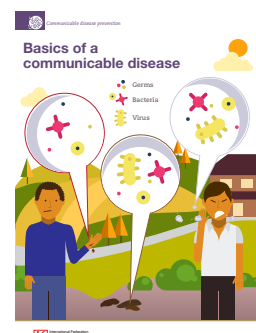
Role of the volunteer reflection questions:

1. How would you describe your role of as a volunteer when thinking about communicable disease prevention in your community?

Basics of communicable diseases

❑ Basics of a communicable disease poster

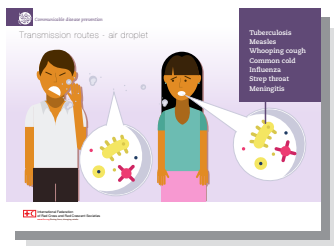
1. Hand out the [Basics of a communicable disease poster](#) and give volunteers a couple of minutes to review the information.
2. Using the poster, ask partners to practise how they would explain each term to community members. Each partner should take a turn. Give them five to seven minutes to practise.
3. Bring volunteers back to a plenary session for reflection questions.



Basics of communicable diseases reflection questions:

1. How do you feel about explaining the basics of communicable diseases to your community?
2. Which terms or concepts will be easy to explain?
3. Which terms or concepts will be difficult to explain?

Transmission routes



Transmission route posters (7)

1. Hand out the seven **Transmission route posters**. Using the posters, briefly review each transmission route.
2. Ask volunteers to confirm that they understand all of the facts presented in the posters. Answer their questions, clarify their misconceptions, and correct misunderstandings.
3. Ask volunteers to break into six groups. Assign a transmission route to each group (faecal-oral has two posters). Give groups about 10 minutes where each volunteer takes a turn practising how to explain the transmission route.
4. Bring volunteers back for a plenary session. Ask one member from each group to present how they would explain the assigned transmission route.

Transmission routes reflection questions:

1. How do you feel about explaining communicable disease transmission routes to members of your community?
2. Which transmission routes will be easy to explain?
3. Which transmission routes will be difficult to explain?

Myths about communicable diseases

1. Ask volunteers to share a myth/misconception/rumour about communicable diseases. Note responses on chart paper.
2. With a partner, ask volunteers to brainstorm ideas about how to address myths, misconceptions, or rumours in their communities. Give partners about 5 minutes to brainstorm.
3. Bring volunteers back for a plenary session. Ask volunteers to share their solutions. Note responses on chart paper. Post chart when completed.

Myths about communicable diseases reflection questions:

1. How do you feel about talking with community members about myths or misconceptions they may hold about communicable diseases?

2. Do you anticipate any particular problems addressing myths or misconceptions? Is there anyone else in the community who could help you with more difficult topics?

Wrap-up

1. Review the learning objectives on the flipchart and ask the volunteers if they feel they have achieved each one.
2. Ask volunteers for any further questions or concerns. It may be necessary to revisit one or two issues to emphasize the importance of communicable disease prevention throughout the community, particularly addressing dispelling myths and misconceptions about the spread of communicable diseases.

Topic 2

Transmission routes

Overview

Learn about communicable diseases by their transmission routes. An introduction to tools to support teaching community members about communicable disease prevention and control. Volunteers are crucial to the prevention and control of communicable diseases in their communities. It is important for volunteers to understand how communicable disease spreads through the concept of “the chain of infection”. Communicable diseases can be prevented by breaking the chain of infection that aids disease spread.

Learning objectives

By the end of this topic, volunteers should be able to:

- Identify key diseases for each transmission route
- Explain how to keep from becoming sick from a communicable disease based on how the disease is spread
- Explain the chain of infection and how to break it
- Identify specific communicable diseases that may affect your community, appropriate prevention and control measures, and the signs and symptoms of specific diseases
- Define the volunteer’s role in protecting their community
- Teach the transmission routes and the chain of infection to their community

Tools

- ❑ Chain of infection poster
- ❑ Disease tools (27)

Suggested outline of activities

Depending on the number of participants and amount of discussion, this topic will take approximately one hour, 50 minutes to complete.

Activity	Time
Introduction	15 minutes
Transmission of communicable diseases	25 minutes
Reflection	10 minutes
Breaking the chain of infection	10 minutes
Reflection	5 minutes
Exploring specific infectious diseases	25 minutes
Reflection	10 minutes
Wrap-up	10 minutes
Total Time	110 minutes

Preparation

- Write the learning objectives for the topic on chart paper and post at the front of the room.
- Prepare copies of the topic and tools from the volunteer guide for each trainee. If necessary, disease tools on sexually-transmitted infections can be divided by gender and then reviewed by male only and female only groups..

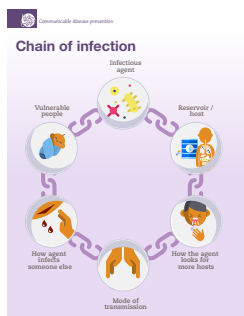
Introduction

1. Welcome the volunteers to the topic. Tell them that this topic explores transmission routes of communicable diseases.
2. Introduce the topic objectives and explain the agenda and activities that they will do to meet those objectives.
3. Distribute the topic **Transmission routes** from the volunteer guide.
 - Explain that volunteers will be taught how to use tools during the session and that they will be expected to practise using these tools and demon-

strate their skill in delivering the content.

- Allow approximately two minutes for the volunteers to become familiar with the topic materials.
4. Instruct volunteers to form groups of three or four. In their groups, volunteers should read the topic **Transmission routes** to themselves or as a group, whichever way they feel more comfortable.
 - After the group has completed reading, they should discuss the Reflection questions from the topic and be prepared for one of them to share their responses with the larger group during a plenary session.
 - Allow approximately 15 minutes for reading and discussion.
 5. After 15 minutes, hold a plenary session and ask each group to present their responses to the Reflection questions. Monitor responses and put right any misunderstandings or misinformation.

Transmission of communicable diseases



Chain of infection poster

1. Hand out the **Chain of infection poster** and give volunteers a couple of minutes to review the information.
2. Using the posters, explain each link in the chain. Explain direct transmission routes and indirect transmission routes. Ask volunteers if they understand all the facts presented in the poster. Answer their questions, clarify any misconceptions, and correct misunderstandings.
3. Ask volunteers to practise explaining the six elements in the chain of infection. With a partner, they should take turns practising. Give them five to seven minutes to practise.
4. Bring volunteers back to a plenary session for reflection questions.

Transmission of communicable diseases reflection questions:

1. How do you feel about teaching the six elements in the chain of infection to your community? Do you feel comfortable explaining the chain of infection poster?
2. Are you comfortable teaching the difference between direct and indirect transmission?
3. Which elements or concepts do you think will be difficult for you to explain within your community?

Preventing communicable disease by breaking the chain of infection

1. Emphasize that communicable diseases can be prevented by breaking an

element/a link in the chain of infection. Review some of the examples provided in the volunteer manual for the topic.

2. Break into six small groups. Give each group a piece of chart paper and a marker. Assign each group an element/link in the chain. Ask the groups to brainstorm ways that their assigned element can be broken and notate their ideas on chart paper. Give groups five to seven minutes to brainstorm.
3. Bring volunteers back to a plenary session. Ask each group to present their ideas. Hang all six charts together on wall.

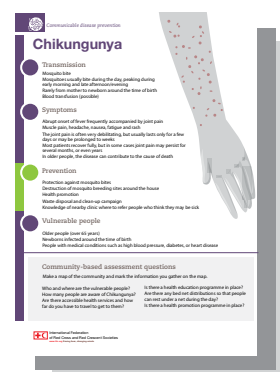
Preventing communicable disease by breaking the chain of infection reflection questions:

1. Do you feel comfortable teaching about breaking the chain of infection and providing examples to your community members?
2. Are there concepts in the chain of infection that may be more difficult for you to teach in your community?

Exploring specific infectious diseases

□ Disease tools (27)

1. Before distributing the disease tools, explain that volunteers will be working in partners, groups or individually to explore various diseases including sexually-transmitted infections. Strongly recommend that partners or groups should be male only or female only as some information is sensitive. (If the group determines mixed gender groups are appropriate then proceed with these groups.) Form partners or groups.
2. Distribute the disease tools. Explain the type of information that is found in each tool. Allow them 5-7 minutes to become comfortable with the materials.
3. Ask partners/groups to explore the disease tools using the following set of questions. These questions are also contained in the topic in the volunteer manual.
 - What are the key diseases for each transmission route?
 - Which diseases have you heard of before?
 - How can you refresh your knowledge of the symptoms, prevention and control methods for each disease?
 - Which animals are unsafe to keep around your home or are unsafe to eat? What diseases can be caused by animals? What can you do to prevent people from getting sick from animals around your home? What can you do to prevent sickness if you have or eat animals?
 - At the bottom of each tool are questions or prompts to help eCBHFA volunteers ensure that Red cross Red Crescent is identifying and meeting the needs of the most vulnerable or excluded groups in their communities. Discuss how volunteers can use this information to make stronger and more resilient communities.
4. Bring volunteers back to a plenary session. Ask volunteers to share their responses to the questions they used to review the disease tools.



Exploring specific infectious diseases reflection questions:

1. Overall, do you feel comfortable about your knowledge of the symptoms, prevention and control methods for each disease?
2. Which disease tools may be difficult for you to teach to your community members?

Wrap-up

1. Review the learning objectives on the flipchart and ask the volunteers if they feel they have achieved each one.
2. Ask volunteers for any further questions or concerns. Address and clarify as needed..

Topic 3

Teaching disease prevention

Overview

Use assessment tools to identify when volunteers should teach communicable disease prevention based on seasonal calendar and other assessments. Communicable diseases that occur regularly in a community can be prevented through teaching about disease prevention before an outbreak occurs. Volunteers must first identify communicable diseases endemic to their community. Through the use of a community's seasonal calendar volunteers can identify how natural weather patterns and community activities can pose potential health risks for each season, activity and festival. Using this data can then help volunteers determine when to teach about disease prevention and control.

Learning objectives

By the end of this topic, volunteers should be able to:

- Identify which communicable diseases are endemic in your area
- Identify when to teach communicable disease prevention based on a seasonal calendar
- Identify which groups within the community will be trained in communicable disease prevention
- Teach other volunteers how to teach about disease prevention

Tools

(from Assessment module)

- ❑ Seasonal calendar for your community
- ❑ Focus group discussion outputs
- ❑ Community action plan
- ❑ Community mapping

Suggested outline of activities

Depending on the number of participants and amount of discussion, this topic will take approximately one hour, 30 minutes to complete.

Activity	Time
Introduction	15 minutes
Identifying communicable diseases in your community	5 minutes
Reflection	10 minutes
Using your community's seasonal calendar to determine when to teach communicable disease prevention	15 minutes
Reflection	10 minutes
Identifying groups within the community to be trained in prevention	15 minutes
Reflection	10 minutes
Wrap-up	10 minutes
Total Time	90 minutes

Preparation

- Write the learning objectives for the topic on chart paper and post at the front of the room.
- Prepare copies of volunteer guide for topic. Tools referenced in this topic are part of the Assessment module.

Introduction

1. Welcome the volunteers to the topic. Tell them that this topic explores teaching about communicable disease prevention.
2. Introduce the topic objectives and explain the agenda and activities that they will do to meet those objectives.
3. Distribute the topic **Teaching disease prevention** from the volunteer guide.
 - Explain that volunteers will review the use of tools learned in the As-

assessment module and demonstrate their skill in delivering the content within this topic.

- Allow approximately two minutes for the volunteers to become familiar with the topic materials.
4. Instruct volunteers to form groups of three or four. In their groups, volunteers should read the topic **Teaching disease prevention** to themselves or as a group, whichever way they feel more comfortable.
 - After the group has completed reading, they should discuss the Reflection questions from the topic and be prepared for one of them to share their responses with the larger group during a plenary session.
 - Allow approximately 15 minutes for reading and discussion.
 5. After 15 minutes, hold a plenary session and ask each group to present their responses to the Reflection questions. Monitor responses and put right any misunderstandings or misinformation.

Identifying communicable diseases in your community

1. Review the difference between endemic and epidemic. Explain what a pandemic is and explain how we need to keep safe in the event of a pandemic.
2. Ask volunteers to turn to a partner and explain the difference between the terms. Each partner should take a turn practicing. Give volunteers 2 to 3 minutes to practice.
3. Remind volunteers that their local clinics and their Ministry of Health can tell them which diseases are endemic in their areas. Ask volunteers to explain about diseases that they know are endemic in their community. Call on several volunteers to explain to the whole groups.

Identifying communicable diseases in your community reflection questions:

1. Do you feel comfortable explaining the difference between endemic and epidemic?
2. Do you feel comfortable asking your department or ministry of health to about diseases endemic to your community?
3. People sometimes talk about pandemics. What is a pandemic? How are eCB-HFA volunteers the best resource to protect community if a pandemic does occur?

Using your community's seasonal calendar to determine when to teach communicable disease prevention

1. Explain to volunteers that their community seasonal calendar can inform them about natural weather patterns that can directly affect community health, such as blizzards, monsoons, heat waves, droughts, cyclones, and hurricanes. Additionally, the calendar should include religious holidays, festivals and other scheduled activities that can affect your community's health. Remind them that volunteers can determine when to teach prevention or send health messages to their community from looking at the seasonal calendar.
2. Ask volunteers to get in partners or small groups. Direct them to consider their own community's seasonal calendar and discuss the following:
 - Details about community's seasonal calendars
 - Details captured from the focus group discussions in their communities
 - Details captured from the community mapping in their communities to identify vulnerable groups and community areas
 - Details from the action plan prepared for their communities
 - Possible communicable diseases that could occur in their communities
 - When they should teach about disease prevention
3. Bring volunteers back to plenary session. Ask groups to share details of their discussions.

Using your community's seasonal calendar to determine when to teach communicable disease prevention reflection questions:

1. On a scale of 1 to 10 (10 being the highest) what is your level of confidence about using the seasonal calendar to determine when to teach about communicable diseases?
2. Do you feel comfortable teaching other volunteers how to use their seasonal calendar to determine when to teach about communicable diseases in their communities?
3. What are you most concerned about teaching related to the seasonal calendar?

Identifying groups within the community to be trained in prevention

1. Remind volunteers that once they have determined when to teach about disease prevention the next step is to determine who to teach about disease prevention.
2. Direct volunteers to get back with the partner or small group from the prior activity. Ask them to consider the following questions when thinking about their community:
 - Who in their community may be affected by the events in their seasonal calendar?
 - What are the different ways they can determine who might be most affected by these events and should be targeted for disease prevention?
3. Bring volunteers back to plenary session. Ask groups to share details of their discussions.

Identifying groups within the community to be trained in prevention reflection questions

1. Do you feel comfortable teaching other volunteers how to use their seasonal calendar and identify who in their community might be affected by these events?
2. What are you most concerned about teaching related to identifying community members who should be trained in disease prevention?

Wrap-up

1. Review the learning objectives on the flipchart and ask the volunteers if they feel they have achieved each one.
2. Ask volunteers for any further questions or concerns. Address and clarify as needed.

Topic 4

Alerting authorities to possible disease outbreak

Overview

General guidance for volunteers on what symptoms, rumours, or occurrences should prompt a volunteer to alert a health authority of possible disease outbreak. Using the community mapping tool from the Assessment module can help volunteers identify disease risk areas, vulnerable people with your community, and community resources. The tool can help you be prepared in case of a disease outbreak or other health emergency. As a volunteer, one of your roles is to alert the authorities if you hear of an odd rumour or learn of an unexpected death or illness. The ability of a volunteer to report to the branch or local clinic can significantly help limit the disease outbreak. It is best to report any unexpected health events to the authorities to help in the prevention of diseases spreading.

Learning objectives

By the end of this topic, volunteers should be able to:

- Develop or modify a community map that includes disease risk areas, vulnerable groups, and community resources.
- Identify when to report odd rumours or unexpected illnesses or deaths, and to whom you should report this.

Tools

- ❑ Community mapping tool (Assessment module)
- ❑ Sample community map (print in colour or in black and white and use a marker to colour code before distributing)
- ❑ Alerting the authorities game

Suggested outline of activities

Depending on the number of participants and amount of discussion, this topic will take approximately one hour, 25 minutes to complete.

Activity	Time
Introduction	20 minutes
Mapping Communicable Disease Risks, Vulnerabilities, and Resources	15 minutes
Reflection	10 minutes
Alerting the authorities	20 minutes
Reflection	10 minutes
Wrap-up	10 minutes
Total Time	85 minutes

Preparation

- Write the learning objectives for the topic on chart paper and post at the front of the room.
- Print copies of volunteer guide for each participant.
- Print colour copies of the sample community map for every four participants.
- Print colour copies of the game pieces. Only print on one side of the paper.

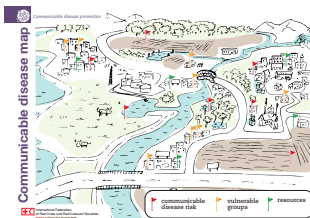
Introduction

1. Introduce the topic objectives and explain the agenda and activities that they will do to meet those objectives.
2. Distribute the topic **Alerting authorities to possible disease outbreak** from the volunteer guide.
 - Explain that volunteers will be taught how to use two tools during the session and that they will be expected to practise using these tools and demonstrate their skill in delivering the content.
 - Allow approximately two minutes for the volunteers to become familiar with the topic materials.
3. Instruct volunteers to form groups of three or four. In their groups, volunteers should read the topic **Alerting authorities to possible disease outbreak**

to themselves or as a group, whichever way they feel more comfortable.

- After the group has completed reading, they should discuss the Reflection questions from the topic and be prepared for one of them to share their responses with the larger group during a plenary session.
 - Allow approximately 15 minutes for reading and discussion.
4. After 15 minutes, hold a plenary session and ask each group to present their responses to the Reflection questions. Monitor responses and put right any misunderstandings or misinformation.

Mapping communicable disease risks, vulnerabilities, and resources



□ Sample community map

1. Remind volunteers about the Community Mapping assessment tool from the Assessment Module. Reinforce the value of the development of community mapping to help identify and map disease risks, determine vulnerable groups, and locate resources to better prevent communicable disease.
2. Ask volunteers to form a small group of 3 or 4. Distribute **Sample community map**. Point out that the map is colour-coded. Red flags indicate disease risks, yellow flags show the location of vulnerable people, and green flags to show the resources available within the community to prevent communicable disease.
3. Ask groups to explore map and identify:
 - Risks you see for communicable diseases. Consider what you know about how diseases are transmitted and to whom. Why do you think these are risks?
 - Vulnerable groups. Explain who you see or evidence of vulnerable groups. What could you do to find more vulnerable people? How could volunteers provide assistance to these people?
 - Resources you see for preventing communicable diseases. Discuss what these resources might be and how they can be used.
4. Allow groups 5 to 7 minutes to explore map. They may write on the map and make assumptions or guesses but should be able to explain their answer.
5. Bring group back to plenary. Ask volunteers to explain what they found on the map using the red flags, yellow flags, and green flags. Where necessary, clarify responses.

Mapping communicable disease risks, vulnerabilities, and resources reflection questions:

1. What do we generally see as risks? How are they related to our knowledge of communicable disease transmission?
2. Who do we generally see as most vulnerable? What do we do about vulnerable people that we may not know or know how to reach?
3. What do we generally see as resources? How are they related to our knowledge of communicable disease prevention?

- Do you feel comfortable teaching about the value of community mapping?

Alerting the authorities

- Emphasize to volunteers that their branch supervisor or local clinic should be notified of any suspicious or unexplained symptoms, deaths, or rumours occurring in their communities. They should err on the side of caution – that is, when uncertain, it is better to be cautious and alert authorities. The authorities can then determine if there is a reason for concern.
- Discuss with the volunteers the example in the volunteer guide of the man who died from diarrhoea. Explain that as the eCBHFA volunteer in their community, they have the responsibility to share any issues of concern with local health authorities – as a way to monitor community health and provide medical support as needed. Ask the group:
 - Why is his death a matter of concern?
 - Who would you talk to about this death?
 - When would you talk to them?
 - How would you talk with his family?
 - What messages might we give to the family?
 - What signs are you looking for when you speak to the family?

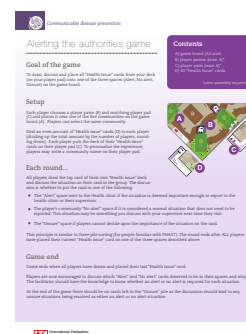
Surveillance

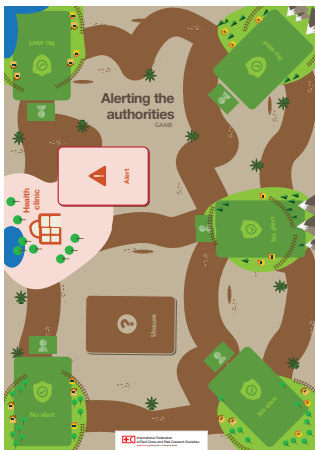
- Discuss the Early Warning and Alert System as outlined in the Volunteer Guide. Consider the Early Warning System in your country.
- Discuss their experience and understanding of the early warning system in use in your country and their critical role in the system.
- Ask:
 - What is the role of eCBHFA volunteers for early surveillance?
 - If other organisations and stakeholders are relying on community input, how are Red Cross Red Crescent volunteers uniquely placed to provide information and data to those who can provide support and medical care?

Let's play!

□ Alerting the authorities game

- Explain that the **Alerting the authorities game** asks game players to use the information learned from this module to determine when they should alert their local authorities about potential communicable disease suspicions. This game helps players work out if they need to share information outside of the community and ensure that they get the right information to the right people at the right time. This might mean phoning the branch supervisor, visiting a neighbouring community, or speaking with the local nurse at a clinic.
- Ask participants to get into groups of 4 to 6 players. Hand out **Alerting the authorities game** to each group.
- Explain the following:
Each group will receive a game kit that contains the following pieces:





- a game board (size: A2),
- a player pawn for up to six players,
- a player pad for each player,
- A stack of event and health cards.
- Directions for game play

They will work together to find and read the directions and begin game play. The objective of the game is to be the first group to draw, discussed and place all of the 'Health issue' cards from their decks.

4. Give them five minutes to start to get settled and assist any groups who may be struggling to get started.
5. Allow 20-30 minutes for the game to be played.
6. After most groups are finished, tell them to start wrapping up and gather for plenary.

Alerting the authorities reflection questions:

1. What did you learn from playing Alerting the Authorities Game?
2. What types of events did your team identify as important to report to authorities? Why?
3. What types of events did your team feel were not necessary to report to authorities? Why?
4. How are eCBHFA volunteers a critical link between community and health authorities? Why is this important?

Wrap-up

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1. Review the learning objectives on the flipchart and ask the volunteers if they feel they have achieved each one.

Topic 5

Basic health messaging

Overview

Basic health messaging guidance includes simplicity, a call to action and communication of a benefit. eCBHFA has many materials that can be used to teach about health and community. But each community is unique and has its own problems, behaviours, norms and reasons that might contribute to unhealthy behaviours or sickness. Volunteers should tailor messages to their community; there is a general set of guiding principles to use when developing written or verbal health messaging. The guidance is simple and should be applied when delivering health content or developing or revising health materials or campaign materials.

Learning objectives

By the end of this topic, volunteers should be able to:

- Explain the use of the doer/non-doer analysis tool for understanding behaviours in the long term and the short term
- Understand the components of a basic health message
- Evaluate basic health messages using the effective message scorecard
- Design a basic health message for the prevention of a communicable disease for a specific community
- Teach basic health messaging to their community

Tools

- ❑ Doer/non-doer analysis tool for behaviour change (from the Assessment module). The assessment module can be found at ifrc-ecbhfa.org/guides-and-tools/
- ❑ Effective message scorecard
- ❑ Sample messages – two messages as found in the toolkit and one down-

loadable cholera video. Download the video in your language from <https://globalhealthmedia.org/animations/>

- How to do doer/non-doer analysis guidance

Suggested outline of activities

Depending on the number of participants and amount of discussion, this topic will take approximately two hours to complete.

Activity	Time
Introduction	20 minutes
Identifying problem behaviours	30 minutes
Reflection	10 minutes
Health messages	40 minutes
Reflection	10 minutes
Wrap-up	10 minutes
Total Time	120 minutes

Preparation

- Write the learning objectives for the topic on chart paper and post at the front of the room.
- Prepare copies of the topic and tools from the volunteer guide for each trainee.

Introduction

1. Welcome the volunteers to the topic. Tell them that this topic explores a general set of guiding principles to use when developing both written and verbal health messaging for their communities.
2. Introduce the topic objectives and explain the agenda and activities that they will do to meet those objectives.
3. Distribute the topic **Basic health messaging** from the volunteer guide.
 - Explain that volunteers will be taught how to use a new tool during the

session and that they will be expected to practise using this tool and demonstrate their skill in delivering the content.

- Allow approximately two minutes for the volunteers to become familiar with the topic materials.
- Instruct volunteers to form groups of three or four. In their groups, volunteers should read the topic **Basic health messaging** to themselves or as a group, whichever way they feel more comfortable.
 - After the group has completed reading, they should discuss the Reflection questions from the topic and be prepared for one of them to share their responses with the larger group during a plenary session.
 - Allow approximately 15 minutes for reading and discussion.
 - After 15 minutes, hold a plenary session and ask each group to present their responses to the Reflection questions. Monitor responses and put right any misunderstandings or misinformation.

Identifying problem behaviours

- Share the doer/non-doer analysis tool from the assessment module.
- Distribute the '**How to use the doer/non-doer analysis tool**' from the toolkit – give one copy to every two participants to share together.
- Refresh volunteers on the use of the doer/non-doer analysis tool, explaining that it is a tool to use when there is a specific problem behaviour that people practice and you want to know more about why the behaviour persists.
- The doer/non-doer analysis tool for behaviour change (from the Assessment module) helps volunteers learn about the reasons behind why existing behaviours exist in their community by identifying the doers (who are already doing the target behaviour) and the non-doers (who are NOT practising the target behaviour). By analysing how and why the Doers practice the behaviour when the Non-Doers do not, eCBHFA volunteers can identify targeted interventions to motivate the Non-Doers to also change their behaviours.
- In a plenary session, ask the volunteers to share with the whole group their experiences of using this assessment tool within their communities.



Identifying problem behaviours reflection questions:

- Considering what you have learnt about communicable disease prevention, what behaviours might you be analysing in your community in the future?
- How can you use the doer/non-doer assessment tool in your community?
- How would you go about doing a Doer/Non-Doer Analysis in your community?

Health messages

Effective message scorecard and sample message / cholera video

- Refresh volunteers on the criteria for effective messages. Prompt them for the four criteria to look for when reviewing.

CRITERIA	3	2	1	Total
Simple Use of simple, clear, direct, easy words	☐	☐	☐	☐
Communication of a benefit Can read or see the good given by doing healthy action	☐	☐	☐	☐
Call to action Clear advice or order to do to achieve the benefit (preventing, treating)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Content appropriate Appropriate for target community, based on experience of only communicable diseases, especially, which is common in the community, in a language involving appropriate imagery, informal and based by community	☐	☐	☐	☐
Score Add the scores for each criterion to produce a total score (0-12 points). An acceptable message must score 8 points or more				☐

2. Hand out the **Effective message scorecard** and **sample message** tools. Point out that the scorecard shows each of the elements of effective messaging in the left column. The other columns are where you write the score you give for each of the four elements of the message you are reviewing.
3. To evaluate a message:
 - First, look at the message and notice your first reaction about what you think the message is about.
 - Then, look at the Effective message scorecard to assess the quality of each message. For each of the four criteria, give your message a score according to which description fits best.
 - Finally, add up the number you gave for each element. If the overall score is below 9 (out of a total of 12), the message needs to be revised (beginning with where it scored lowest).
4. Ask volunteers to individually look at one of the **sample messages in the toolkit**. Show and read the sample message to the group.
5. Lead the group in reviewing the message and using the **Effective messaging scorecard** to score each element of effective messaging. Discuss why you give each score and answer any questions they may have.
6. Now give them the second **sample message** from the toolkit. Have them work with one partner to use the scorecard and review the second sample message for effectiveness. Give them two minutes.
7. After two minutes, ask the group to share their scores. Ask volunteers to explain their scores. Start with the first element, Simplicity, and ask volunteers how many scored this a 4? A 3? A 2? A 1? After each vote, ask for explanations of why they gave that score. Help the group come to a consensus about the actual score for this element. Where necessary, help point out why this item received a high or a low score. Repeat these steps for the other three elements.
8. Finally show the cholera video. Once the video finishes, have them work with their same partner to use the scorecard and review the video as a health message for effectiveness. Give them two minutes.
9. After two minutes, ask the group to share their scores. Ask volunteers to explain their scores. Start with the first element, Simplicity, and ask volunteers how many scored this a 4? A 3? A 2? A 1? After each vote, ask for explanations of why they gave that score. Help the group come to a consensus about the actual score for this element. Where necessary, help point out why this item received a high or a low score. Repeat these steps for the other three elements.
10. With their same partner, ask volunteers to develop a sample message about any aspect of communicable disease using the **Effective messaging scorecard** as a guide to ensure you have all elements addressed. Once finished, ask partners to join with another group of partners. Within the group, ask partners to switch messages and score another team's message using the **Effective messaging scorecard**. When finished, ask partner teams to share their scores.
11. In a plenary session, ask several volunteers to read the message they wrote and give the score. Ask the whole group if they agree with scores. Discuss and come to a consensus about scores where appropriate.



Health messages reflection questions:

1. On a scale of one to ten (ten being the highest) what is your level of confidence about writing health messages?
2. Which elements of writing a health message are difficult for you? Which elements are easier for you to accomplish?
3. Do you feel comfortable using the **Effective message scorecard** when you are writing a health message?
4. Do you feel comfortable teaching other volunteers how to write an effective health message?

Wrap-up

1. Review the learning objectives on the flipchart and ask the volunteers if they feel they have achieved each one.
2. Ask volunteers for any lingering questions or concerns.

[illegible]

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dotted lines, resembling notebook paper. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There is no handwriting or other markings on the paper.

The fundamental principles of the international Red Cross and Red Crescent movement

Humanity The international Red Cross and Red Crescent movement, born of a desire to bring assistance without discrimination to the wounded on the battlefield, endeavours, in its international and national capacity, to prevent and alleviate human suffering wherever it may be found. Its purpose is to protect life and health and to ensure respect for the human being. It promotes mutual understanding, friendship, cooperation and lasting peace amongst all peoples.

Impartiality It makes no discrimination as to nationality, race, religious beliefs, class or political opinions. It endeavours to relieve the suffering of individuals, being guided solely by their needs, and to give priority to the most urgent cases of distress.

Neutrality In order to enjoy the confidence of all, the Movement may not take sides in hostilities or engage at any time in controversies of a political, racial, religious or ideological nature.

Independence The movement is independent. The National Societies, while auxiliaries in the humanitarian services of their governments and subject to the laws of their respective countries, must always maintain their autonomy so that they may be able at all times to act in accordance with the principles of the Movement.

Voluntary service It is a voluntary relief movement not prompted in any manner by desire for gain.

Unity There can be only one Red Cross or Red Crescent Society in any one country. It must be open to all. It must carry on its humanitarian work throughout its territory.

Universality The international Red Cross and Red Crescent movement, in which all societies have equal status and share equal responsibilities and duties in helping each other, is worldwide.

For more information on this IFRC publication, please contact:

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Red Crescent Societies
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